Jothi Teaching Standards

Jothi Parent Communication Standard

Operational standard for communicating student progress clearly, professionally, and in a way that supports learning

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Purpose of the Document

This document defines the standard for parent communication within the Jothi Tutor Academy. Its purpose is to ensure that communication with parents remains clear, professional, evidence-based, and supportive of the student's academic development.

At Jothi, communication with parents is not treated as a casual add-on to teaching. It is part of the wider learning system. Good parent communication helps parents understand how the student is progressing, what difficulties are emerging, and what support or action is needed next. Poor communication, by contrast, creates confusion, weakens trust, and can misrepresent the student's real learning position.

This standard exists to make parent communication consistent, useful, and aligned with the wider teaching model of the academy.

Intended Audience

This document is intended for:

- tutors communicating with parents or guardians
- mentors supporting tutors in professional communication
- academy leadership overseeing communication quality and consistency

Related JTA Documents

- JTS01 — Lesson Delivery Standard
- JTS03 — Assessment and Progress Monitoring Standard
- JTS05 — Teaching Environment and Technology Standard
- JTD04 — Mentor Observation Standard

1. Purpose of Parent Communication in the Jothi System

Parent communication at Jothi should serve a clear academic purpose. It should help parents understand:

- how the student is engaging in lessons
- what the student currently understands well
- where the student is struggling or insecure
- what progress is being made over time
- what action or support is needed next

The aim is not simply to provide updates. The aim is to create a more informed partnership around the student's learning.

2. Principles of Effective Parent Communication

Effective parent communication should be:

- clear
- accurate
- constructive
- evidence-based
- professionally toned
- respectful of the student

Communication should be honest without becoming harsh, encouraging without becoming vague, and practical without becoming overly technical.

3. What Parent Communication Should Be Based On

Parent communication should be grounded in real evidence from the student's learning experience.

This may include:

- lesson engagement
- response to explanation and questioning
- assessment performance
- patterns in misunderstanding
- quality of homework or independent work
- improvement in confidence, reasoning, or consistency
- areas that require further consolidation

Tutors should avoid sending updates based only on general impression or mood. The strongest communication is anchored in observed learning.

4. Relationship to Teaching and Assessment

Parent communication should reflect the actual teaching and assessment process.

This means that updates should where appropriate be informed by:

- what has been taught recently
- how the student responded during lessons
- what assessment evidence shows
- whether misconceptions are being resolved
- whether the student is ready to move forward or needs further support

This connection matters because parents should receive a meaningful picture of learning, not just broad reassurance.

5. Types of Parent Communication

5.1 Routine Progress Updates

Routine updates should summarise how the student is progressing over time. They may include:

- topics covered
- current strengths
- areas needing reinforcement
- patterns in attitude, focus, or consistency where relevant

- suggested next priorities

These updates should be concise but informative.

5.2 Assessment-Based Updates

Where a recent test, review, or significant piece of work provides useful evidence, communication should explain:

- what the student did well
- what remains insecure
- whether errors were conceptual or procedural
- what should happen next

Marks alone are usually not enough. Parents benefit more from understanding what the result means.

5.3 Concern-Based Communication

Where there is a meaningful concern, such as repeated lack of preparation, poor attendance, persistent misunderstanding, or weak follow-through, communication should be timely and professional.

Concern-based communication should:

- state the issue clearly
- avoid exaggeration
- explain why the issue matters for learning
- indicate what action is needed

5.4 Guidance and Support Messages

Some communication may focus on helping parents support the student more effectively. This may include advice on:

- revision focus
- homework routines
- upcoming academic priorities
- exam preparation

- attendance and consistency

Such messages should remain practical and proportionate.

6. Tone and Professionalism

Tutors must maintain a professional tone in all parent communication.

This means communication should be:

- polite
- respectful
- calm
- clear
- free from emotional overreaction
- focused on learning rather than personal judgement

Tutors should avoid:

- overly casual language
- speculative claims
- emotional language about the student
- criticism that is not supported by evidence
- messages that create unnecessary alarm

Professional communication protects both the relationship and the credibility of the academy.

7. Clarity and Brevity

Parent communication should be clear enough for a non-specialist reader to understand without difficulty.

Tutors should:

- avoid unnecessary jargon
- explain academic issues in plain language
- keep messages focused on the most useful points

- distinguish clearly between strengths, concerns, and next steps

A brief clear message is stronger than a long unclear one.

8. Supporting Student Motivation

Communication with parents should support learning without undermining the student's confidence.

Tutors should communicate in a way that:

- acknowledges real progress honestly
- treats mistakes as part of learning
- identifies areas for improvement without labelling the student negatively
- keeps the focus on effort, understanding, and next steps

The goal is to strengthen support around the student, not to create blame.

9. Communication Channels and Boundaries

Parent communication should take place through approved academy channels and in line with Jothi's communication processes.

Tutors should:

- use authorised communication routes
- maintain appropriate professional boundaries
- keep communication focused on academic matters and agreed support
- escalate issues through internal processes when needed

Tutors should not allow parent communication to become informal, excessive, or disconnected from academy oversight.

10. Confidentiality and Respect

Tutors must handle student information with care.

This means:

- sharing learning-related information only with authorised individuals
- avoiding careless discussion of student difficulties
- describing student performance respectfully
- protecting the dignity of the student even when discussing concerns

Respect is not optional. It is part of professional teaching conduct.

11. Common Parent Communication Errors

The following practices weaken parent communication and should be avoided:

- giving vague updates with little real information
- over-relying on marks without explaining understanding
- making claims that are not supported by lesson evidence
- sounding defensive, casual, or overly emotional
- focusing only on problems and ignoring genuine progress
- offering reassurance that is too general to be useful
- communicating concerns too late after the pattern is already serious
- using language that may embarrass or demotivate the student

These mistakes reduce trust and make communication less useful for learning.

12. What Mentors Should Look For

Where parent communication is reviewed, mentors should look for evidence that the tutor:

- communicates clearly and professionally
- bases updates on real lesson and assessment evidence
- explains progress in a way parents can understand
- balances honesty with constructive support
- identifies sensible next steps where needed
- maintains appropriate boundaries

Mentors should also consider whether the communication reflects the academy's teaching standards rather than sounding generic or improvised.

13. Relationship to the Wider JTA System

This standard supports the wider JTA system by ensuring that parent communication reflects what is actually happening in teaching and assessment.

It is closely connected to:

- JTS01, because lesson quality shapes the evidence available for communication
- JTS03, because assessment evidence helps make updates specific and meaningful
- JTS05, because communication in an online academy depends on reliable systems and professional technical setup

Parent communication is therefore not separate from the teaching system. It is one of the ways that learning progress is communicated, supported, and kept accountable.

14. Conclusion

Parent communication at Jothi should be clear, evidence-based, and academically useful. Tutors are expected to communicate in a way that helps parents understand real progress, real difficulty, and the next steps needed to support the student well.

This standard exists to ensure that communication remains professional, consistent, and aligned with the wider teaching model of the academy.